Test 16:

READING PASSAGE 1

A survivor's story

One native bird in New Zealand that has managed to survive the introduction of non-native species

As an island country with a fauna dominated by birds, New Zealand was once home to an owl species which is now extinct, the laughing owl, named for its distinctive cry. This bird was widespread throughout the islands when European settlers arrived in the middle of the 19th century and it remained in good numbers for some years thereafter. Where other native birds suffered from predation by the Polynesian rat, the laughing owl turned the tables and adapted its diet to include the rodent. It was also capable of catching and killing the other New Zealand owl, the morepork, and even larger birds, such as the weka. However, the laughing owl was wiped out around the beginning of the 20th century, its demise caused by specimen collectors, habitat changes, and non-native predators including cats and stoats. Surprisingly, it is the smaller owl, the morepork, that has managed to survive until this day.

Speckled dark brown, with yellow eyes and long tails, they are around 29 centimetres long from head to tail and 175 grams in weight. Moreporks have fringes on the edge of their feathers, so they can fly almost silently and not alert potential prey. They have acute hearing and their large eyes are very sensitive to light.

Moreporks nest in tree hollows, in clumps of plants, or in cavities among rocks and roots. In the wild, moreporks usually start nesting in October, although two specimens have been recorded nesting in mid-winter, possibly stimulated by an ample food supply. The female lays up to three white eggs, which she incubates for 20 to 30 days. During this time, she rarely hunts, and the male brings food to her.

Once the chicks hatch, she stays mainly on the nest until the young owls are fully feathered. When hatched, chicks are covered in light grey down and have their eyes closed. The eyes do not open until the eighth day after hatching. They can fly at around 35 days.

By day, moreporks sleep in roosts. By night, they hunt a variety of animals – mainly large invertebrates including scarab and huhu beetles, moths, caterpillars and spiders. They also

take small birds and mice. They can find suitable food in pine forest as well as native forest. A morepork uses its sharp talons to catch or stun its prey, which it then carries away in its bill. Moreporks are clever hunters, and birds such as robins, grey warblers and fantails can end up as their prey. In the day, these small birds sometimes mob drowsy moreporks and chase them away from their roosts; they force the sleepy predators to search for a more peaceful spot.

Moreporks have proved to be ungracious hosts. Scientists trying to establish a population of plovers on Motuora Island in New Zealand's Hauraki Gulf were mystified as to why only two birds survived out of the 75 placed there. The culprits turned out to be five pairs of moreporks that ate or chased away the new arrivals.

Although moreporks are still considered to be relatively common, it is likely that numbers are in gradual decline due to predation and loss of habitat. As the female is a hole-nester, she is vulnerable to predators such as stoats and possums during the breeding season, and eggs and chicks will also be at risk from rats. The use of pesticides is another possible threat to the owls, though not a direct one. As moreporks are at the top of the food chain, they could be affected by an accumulative poison by consuming prey that has ingested poison.

The New Zealand Department of Conservation is taking steps to ensure the preservation of New Zealand's only native owl. The department is involved in measuring the population of moreporks and has put transmitters on a number of birds to determine survival and mortality. As well as being New Zealand's only native owl, the morepork has symbolic and spiritual importance, so in monitoring the birds it is hoped that the morepork will continue to survive and thrive.

At dusk, the melancholy sound of the morepork can be heard in forests and parks as it calls to other moreporks and claims territory. Its Māori name *(ruru)* echoes its two-part cry. In the tradition of the Māori people of New Zealand, the morepork, or ruru, was often seen as a careful guardian. A number of sayings referred to the bird's alertness. As a bird of the night, it was associated with the spirit world. Moreporks were believed to act as messengers to the gods in the heavens, flying along spiritual paths in the sky. They were the mediums used to communicate with the gods. The occasional high, piercing call of the morepork signified bad news, but the lower-pitched and more common "ruru" call heralded good news.

Questions 1–7

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

In boxes 1–7 on your answer sheet, write

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information*

FALSE *if the statement contradicts the information*

NOT GIVEN *if there is no information on this*

1 Early European settlers made detailed studies of the morepork.

2 The Polynesian rat had a negative effect on the number of laughing owls.

3 The laughing owl was larger than the morepork.

4 Rats pose a risk to young moreporks.

5 The New Zealand Department of Conservation is hoping to limit the population of moreporks.

6 Other bird species are frightened away when they hear the morepork's cry.

7 In Māori tradition, the low call of the morepork had negative associations.

Questions 8–13

Complete the notes below.

*Choose **ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 8–13 on your answer sheet.

The Morepork

Appearance

- approximately **8** _____ in length
- feathers with fringes to enable quiet flight

Nesting

- nests in trees, plants or spaces in roots and **9** _____
- after about 35 days, baby moreporks are capable of leaving the nest

Hunting

- transports its prey using its **10** _____
- can be chased away by other birds during the **11** _____
- attacked **12** _____ that had been introduced to Motuora Island

Threats

- may be exposed to **13** _____ in their prey

ĐÁP ÁN:

1. NOT GIVEN (Bài đọc chỉ nói chim ruru phổ biến khi người định cư châu Âu đến, không đề cập họ có nghiên cứu chi tiết về nó hay không)

2. FALSE (Ngược lại với các loài chim khác, chim cú cười đã thích nghi và ăn thịt chuột Polynesian để tồn tại)

3. TRUE (Bài đọc gọi ruru/morepork là "loài cú nhỏ hơn" so với cú cười)

4. TRUE (Trứng và chim non ruru gặp rủi ro từ loài chuột)

5. FALSE (Bộ Bảo tồn đang thực hiện các bước để đảm bảo sự bảo tồn/duy trì loài chim này, không phải hạn chế số lượng)

6. NOT GIVEN (Bài đọc nói các loài chim khác xua đuổi ruru vào ban ngày, nhưng không nói chúng sợ hãi khi nghe tiếng kêu của nó)

7. FALSE (Tiếng kêu thấp "ruru" báo hiệu tin tốt, chỉ có tiếng kêu cao và chói tai mới báo hiệu tin xấu)

8. 29 centimetres (Chiều dài từ đầu đến đuôi của chim ruru)

9. rocks (Chúng làm tổ trong hốc cây, lùm cây hoặc hốc giữa đá và rễ cây)

10. bill (Chúng dùng móng vuốt để bắt mồi nhưng dùng mỏ để mang con mồi đi)

11. day (Vào ban ngày, các loài chim nhỏ thường quấy rối và xua đuổi ruru khỏi nơi trú ẩn)

12. plovers (Ruru đã tấn công và ăn thịt loài chim plover được đưa đến đảo Motuora)

13. poison (Ruru có thể bị ảnh hưởng bởi chất độc tích tụ khi ăn phải những con mồi đã nhiễm độc)

READING PASSAGE 2

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 14-26**, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.*

Questions 14 – 19

Reading Passage 2 has six sections, **A-F**.

Choose the correct heading for each section from the list of headings below.

*Write the correct number, **i-viii**, in boxes 14-19 on your answer sheet.*

List of Headings

i Sending messages underground
ii Potential advantages for farmers
iii The widespread rejection of an idea
iv One species accelerating growth in another
v Some obstacles to plant communication
vi Evidence leading to renewed belief in a theory
vii New technologies which helped researchers
viii A suggested benefit to the sender of plant communication

14 Section A

15 Section B

16 Section C

17 Section D

18 Section E

19 Section F

How do plants talk to each other?

Research shows that plants communicate and interact with each other in surprisingly subtle and sophisticated ways.

A In 1983, plant scientists Jack Schultz and Ian Baldwin reported that healthy young maple trees increased their defense systems when exposed to maples that had been damaged by plant-eating (herbivorous) insects. The injured trees, they suggested, were alerting neighbours to the presence of a predator by releasing chemical signals into the air. But the plant research community did not accept this. The results were difficult to replicate, critics pointed out. Many also questioned how a trait could be evolutionarily stable if it benefited neighboring plants but not the plant releasing the signal. By the late 1980s, most ecologists felt that Schultz and Baldwin's ideas had been discredited.

B A decade later, however, a number of more carefully designed experiments began to yield convincing indications to the contrary. In 2000, evolutionary ecologist Richard Karban showed that wild tobacco plants became resistant to herbivores when grown in close proximity to sagebrush plants whose leaves had been damaged by cutting. This change appeared to be in response to chemicals — known as volatile organic compounds or VOCs — released by the sagebrush plants. Other researchers soon reported similar VOC-induced defense responses in several other plants, including lima bean, broad bean, barley, and corn. And in 2006, Karban showed that VOCs released by damaged sagebrush induce herbivore resistance in plants growing at distances of up to 60 cm, well within the range of sagebrush neighbors in nature.

C But the question still remains: 'Why should a plant waste valuable resources on a function which has no obvious advantage for it?' One hypothesis is that external communication channels are merely an extension of within-plant signaling. In sagebrush, lima bean, and poplar, VOCs released from damaged parts of a plant induce resistance in intact sections of the same plant, suggesting that each individual plant uses the signals to coordinate its own physiological responses to protect itself. Karban agrees, saying, 'The interplant signaling we see may be a result of plants co-opting that process.' Alternatively, VOC-based signaling between plants may have been favored because it enhances the 'extended fitness' of the sender by aiding related plants of the same species: a strategy known as kin selection.

D Over the past few years, a team led by Ariel Novoplansky of Ben-Gurion University of the Negev in Israel seems to have found proof that distress signals can be passed through the plants' roots. They planted garden pea plants in rows and subjected the first in each row to conditions similar to those experienced in a drought. They then evaluated the response by

measuring the microscopic holes on leaves, known as pores, which react when there is a shortage of water. After fifteen minutes, the stressed plant was seen to be closing its pores, followed by all of its neighbors, one by one. Importantly, in a control setup where root contact between neighboring plants was blocked, pores stayed open. Meanwhile, David Johnson's team at the University of Aberdeen in Scotland have been studying the labyrinths of hair-like fungi that occur around the roots of most plants. These fungi are involved in an important two-way relationship: in exchange for sugars, they provide plants with much-needed phosphorus and nitrogen. Research in which broad bean plants were infested with aphids — small herbivorous insects — revealed that these networks also served as a channel for warning neighboring plants of the infestation.

E Monica Gagliano of the University of Western Australia believes that plants may even use sounds to alert their neighbours. In one study, she demonstrated that chili plants planted next to fennel plants developed more quickly than seedlings grown with other chili plants. Gagliano and her colleagues suspect the chili plants were compensating for the presence of the fennel, which is known to release chemicals that inhibit the growth of other plants. Remarkably, however, all known plant communication pathways — airborne volatiles, root contact, and common fungal networks — were blocked. The results begged for an alternative explanation. 'We think this other channel of communication might be acoustic,' says Gagliano. But behavioral ecologist Carel ten Cate of the University of Leiden in the Netherlands points out that taking advantage of such benefits would require sensory mechanisms yet to be described in plants. Despite widespread skepticism, Gagliano has received some encouragement. Richard Karban, for example, is cautiously enthusiastic. 'Whether or not the explanation she favors is the right one,' he says, 'I think that she's gotten results that, as a field, we need to come to grips with.'

F Researchers believe that knowledge of this phenomenon could eventually be applied to agriculture, and lead to the cultivation of hardier crops. All agree that there is still much work to be done. 'Applying our limited knowledge [of plant-communication mechanisms] to agriculture is a big jump,' says Johnson, 'but it is definitely on the horizon.' Nevertheless, one message has emerged loud and clear from those studying this new realm of botanical interaction: despite not possessing eyes, ears, or a nervous system, plants are anything but uncommunicative. 'When I did my PhD [in the late 1980s], all this stuff was considered very weird,' recalls Ariel Novoplansky. 'Today, there's no doubt. We now recognise that plants are capable of some very sophisticated exchanges of information with other plants. This idea is not strange anymore.'

Questions 20 – 23

Complete the summary below.

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answer in boxes 20-23 on your answer sheet.

Plant communication research in Israel and Scotland

Plants may send messages via their **20** ..... according to Ariel Novoplansky of Ben-Gurion University in Israel. In one study, Novoplansky's team planted rows of garden peas, and created conditions like a **21** ..... around the first plant in each row. The plants responded by closing the tiny holes on their leaf surfaces, known as pores. They then appeared to signal to other plants nearby, causing them to respond in a similar way.

Research at the University of Aberdeen in Scotland, meanwhile, has focused on the networks of **22** ..... which connect the plants beneath the soil. These structures, which extract sugars from the plants and supply them with phosphorus and nitrogen, also seem to play a key role in plant communication. Experiments involving broad bean plants and plant-eating insects called **23** ..... have also produced some interesting results.

Questions 24 – 26

Look at the following statements (Questions 24-26) and the list of researchers below.

Match each statement with the correct researcher, ***A-E****.*

Write the correct letter, ***A-E****, in boxes 24-26 on your answer sheet.*

24 It is likely that research into plant communication will one day help to improve our food supply.

25 Plant communication could occur as a consequence of internal mechanisms intended to help a single plant.

26 Attitudes towards plant communication have changed greatly in recent decades.

List of Researchers

A Richard Karban
B Ariel Novoplansky
C David Johnson
D Monica Gagliano
E Carel ten Cate

ĐÁP ÁN:

14. iii

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

But the plant research community did not accept this. The results were difficult to replicate, critics pointed out. Many also questioned how a trait could be evolutionarily stable if it benefited neighboring plants but not the plant releasing the signal. By the late 1980s, most ecologists felt that Schultz and Baldwin's ideas had been discredited.

(Tuy nhiên, cộng đồng nghiên cứu thực vật không chấp nhận điều này. Các nhà phê bình chỉ ra rằng kết quả rất khó được lặp lại trong các thí nghiệm khác. Nhiều người cũng đặt câu hỏi làm thế nào một đặc điểm có thể được duy trì qua tiến hóa nếu nó chỉ mang lại lợi ích cho các cây lân cận chứ không phải cây phát tín hiệu. Đến cuối những năm 1980, phần lớn các nhà sinh thái học cho rằng những ý tưởng của Schultz và Baldwin đã bị bác bỏ.)

15. vi

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

A decade later, however, a number of more carefully designed experiments began to yield convincing indications to the contrary.

(Tuy nhiên, mười năm sau, hàng loạt thí nghiệm được thiết kế cẩn thận hơn đã đưa ra những bằng chứng thuyết phục theo hướng ngược lại.)

16. viii

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

One hypothesis is that external communication channels are merely an extension of within-plant signaling….Alternatively, VOC-based signaling between plants may have been favored because it enhances the 'extended fitness' of the sender by aiding related plants of the same species: a strategy known as kin selection.

(Một giả thuyết cho rằng các kênh giao tiếp bên ngoài chỉ đơn thuần là sự mở rộng của hệ thống truyền tín hiệu bên trong cây…..Một giả thuyết khác cho rằng việc truyền tín hiệu bằng các hợp chất hữu cơ dễ bay hơi (VOC) giữa các cây được duy trì vì nó làm tăng "khả năng thích nghi mở rộng" của cây phát tín hiệu bằng cách giúp đỡ những cây cùng loài có quan hệ họ hàng, một chiến lược được gọi là chọn lọc họ hàng.)

17. i

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Over the past few years, a team led by Ariel Novoplansky of Ben-Gurion University of the Negev in Israel seems to have found proof that distress signals can be passed through the plants' roots.

(Trong vài năm gần đây, một nhóm nghiên cứu do Ariel Novoplansky thuộc Đại học Ben-Gurion vùng Negev (Israel) dẫn đầu dường như đã tìm thấy bằng chứng cho thấy các tín hiệu báo động có thể được truyền qua rễ của thực vật.)

18. iv

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

In one study, she demonstrated that chili plant seedlings grown next to fennel plants developed more quickly than seedlings grown with other chili plants.

(Trong một nghiên cứu, bà đã chứng minh rằng các cây ớt con được trồng cạnh cây thì là phát triển nhanh hơn so với các cây ớt con được trồng cạnh những cây ớt khác.)

19. v

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Researchers believe that knowledge of this phenomenon would actually be applied to agriculture, and lead to the cultivation of hardier crops.

(Các nhà nghiên cứu tin rằng hiểu biết về hiện tượng này có thể được áp dụng vào nông nghiệp, từ đó giúp trồng được những loại cây trồng có sức chống chịu tốt hơn.)

20. roots

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Over the past few years, a team led by Ariel Novoplansky of Ben-Gurion University of the Negev in Israel seems to have found proof that distress signals can be passed through the plants' roots.

(Trong vài năm gần đây, một nhóm nghiên cứu do Ariel Novoplansky thuộc Đại học Ben-Gurion vùng Negev (Israel) dẫn đầu dường như đã tìm thấy bằng chứng cho thấy các tín hiệu báo động có thể được truyền qua rễ của thực vật.)

21. drought

(Trong một nghiên cứu, nhóm của Novoplansky đã trồng các hàng cây đậu Hà Lan và tạo ra điều kiện giống như một đợt _____ đối với cây đầu tiên trong mỗi hàng.)

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

They planted garden pea plants in rows and subjected the first in each row to conditions similar to those experienced in a drought.

22. fungi

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Meanwhile, David Johnson's team at the University of Aberdeen in Scotland have been studying the labyrinths of hair-like fungi that occur around the roots of most plants.

(Trong khi đó, nhóm của David Johnson tại Đại học Aberdeen (Scotland) đã nghiên cứu mạng lưới phức tạp gồm các loại nấm dạng sợi mảnh như lông phát triển xung quanh rễ của hầu hết các loài thực vật.)

23. aphids

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Research in which broad bean plants were infested with aphids – small herbivorous insects – revealed that these networks also served as a channel for warning neighboring plants of the infestation.

(Một nghiên cứu, trong đó cây đậu tằm bị rệp (aphids) – những côn trùng nhỏ ăn thực vật – tấn công, đã cho thấy rằng mạng lưới này cũng đóng vai trò như một kênh truyền tín hiệu để cảnh báo các cây lân cận về sự xâm nhập của rệp.)

24. C

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

Researchers believe that knowledge of this phenomenon would actually be applied to agriculture, and lead to the cultivation of hardier crops. They all agree that there is still much work to be done. 'Applying our limited knowledge [of plant-communication mechanisms] to agriculture is a big jump,' says Johnson, 'but it is definitely on the horizon.'

(Các nhà nghiên cứu tin rằng hiểu biết về hiện tượng này cuối cùng sẽ được ứng dụng vào nông nghiệp, từ đó giúp trồng được những loại cây có sức chống chịu tốt hơn. Tuy nhiên, họ đều đồng ý rằng vẫn còn rất nhiều việc phải làm. Johnson nói: "Việc áp dụng những hiểu biết còn hạn chế của chúng ta về cơ chế giao tiếp của thực vật vào nông nghiệp là một bước tiến rất lớn, nhưng điều đó chắc chắn sẽ sớm trở thành hiện thực.")

25. A

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

One hypothesis is that external communication channels are merely an extension of within-plant signaling.

Karban agrees, saying, 'The interplant signaling we see may be a result of plants co-opting that process.'

(Một giả thuyết cho rằng sự giao tiếp giữa các cây chỉ là sự mở rộng của hệ thống truyền tín hiệu bên trong cùng một cây.

Karban đồng ý và nói:"Việc truyền tín hiệu giữa các cây mà chúng ta quan sát được có thể là kết quả của việc cây tận dụng chính cơ chế đó.")

26. B

Đoạn chứa đáp án:

'When I did my PhD [in the late 1980s], all this stuff was considered very weird,' recalls Ariel Novoplansky. 'Today, there's no doubt. We now recognise that plants are capable of some very sophisticated exchanges of information with other plants. This idea is not strange anymore.'

(Ariel Novoplansky nhớ lại: "Khi tôi làm nghiên cứu sinh tiến sĩ (vào cuối những năm 1980), tất cả những điều này đều bị xem là rất kỳ lạ." "Ngày nay thì không còn nghi ngờ gì nữa. Chúng ta hiện đã công nhận rằng thực vật có khả năng trao đổi thông tin với những cây khác bằng những cách rất tinh vi. Ý tưởng này giờ đây không còn bị coi là kỳ lạ nữa.")

TRUE IELTS

READING PASSAGE 3

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27–40**, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

All in the family

A person's brothers and sisters can have a powerful effect on their adult behaviour

We can choose our friends, the saying goes, but we cannot choose our family of origin. Our parents provide the genetic material and make powerful early role models, but even more influential in determining what kind of adult we will become are our brothers and sisters – our siblings. They occupy a position of unique intimacy in our lives and cast a longer shadow than many recognise or are prepared to acknowledge. By turns enraging and lovable, familiar and mysterious, our brothers and sisters are the human beings who people our first social relationships. And a sibling relationship is the most enduring relationship many of us will ever have, less emotionally intense than the bonds we form with our spouses and our own children if only because they started when we were so young.

Surprising new research by Dr Gene Brody found that having older children who do well in school and are well liked by other children leads to parental 'basking' – increasing mothers' self-esteem. It is clear that in turn this is associated with more positive parenting of younger children, who display fewer behavioural problems as a result. Conversely, parents who get a difficult first child may in turn experience a negative spiral of household tension.

International sports star Piri Weepu is a rugby hard man, but at least some of his tough temperament was forged long ago in the family home. His older brother Billy started rugby-tackling little Piri when he was just four – to 'harden him up'. It seemed to work: Piri followed his brother in playing for the under-sevens league before he even started school. There are as many such stories as there are families: in the formative hothouse of the family, siblings interact in complex ways with the powerful forcefields of parents, genetics and personality already at work. It starts with birth order, which determines play roles: the firstborn leader, the middle-child mediator and the rebellious youngest. These are roles that can stick for life.

Clinical psychologist Claire Cartwright says she has clients who believe, and it might not have been true, that they were treated differently from their siblings, that one child in the family was preferred over others. They are quite convinced that the parental judgements on them all those years ago were harsher, and that they were the ones who always got into trouble. Later, in the workplace, such a person might be particularly defensive, and so behave in a way more prone to attracting harsh judgements.

However, the research shows that being Mummy or Daddy's favourite has its own traps. If you were the easy-going, co-operative child at home, you probably excelled at pleasing parents and, later, bosses. But you might, as an adult, find it hard to be assertive with authority figures and lack direction. On the other hand, the sibling who is disruptive and

annoying as a child may be able to reinterpret that role later, turning those attention-seeking characteristics into strengths like determination and leadership.

How is it that full siblings, despite sharing DNA, can turn out so differently? One answer is that, in fact, each sibling grows up in a different family, a unique micro-culture. For example, the firstborn is, for a while, an only child, and therefore has a completely different experience of the parents than those born later. The parents themselves are growing up too, weathering hardship or good fortune, so one sibling might experience stability and closeness while another might be raised in the midst of crisis.

Of course, there are many positive aspects of sibling relationships. Annette Henderson, a lecturer in psychology, says firstborn children learn vocabulary more quickly than their siblings because they are not competing to spend one-on-one time with parents. But younger children in turn benefit from unintentional instruction from their bigger brothers and sisters, acquiring entire phrases and an understanding of social concepts such as politeness. Similarly, a Cambridge University study of 140 children found that even when there is a great deal of conflict, siblings will still create a rich world of play and make-believe that extends them developmentally. Love-hate relationships were common among the children, but even those who fought the most had as many positive interactions as the other sibling pairs. It is also true that children compete for parental attention by making themselves different from their brothers and sisters, particularly if they are close in age. A 2003 research paper studied adolescents from 185 families over two years, finding that those who changed, to differentiate themselves from their siblings, increased the amount of warmth they gained from parents, and also developed stronger personalities and a better sense of their own identity.

Another consideration is that many families today are smaller and more intimate than their historical counterparts. This may be advantageous because siblings tend to know each other better and remain lifelong friends compared to children from bigger or more widely spaced families, who perhaps lose touch with one another after leaving home. Then there was a 2010 American study which found that having a sister, whether younger or older, meant that 10- to 14-year-olds were less likely to feel lonely, unloved, self-conscious or fearful. The same study found that having a loving sibling of either gender promoted good deeds, such as helping a neighbour around the house or helping other children at school.

Questions 27–30

Do the following statements agree with the claim of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 27–30 on your answer sheet, write

YES — if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer
NO — if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer
NOT GIVEN — if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

27 Parents and siblings play equal roles in shaping people's adult personalities.

28 People's first social relationships tend to be with siblings of their own gender.

29 People's relationships with their siblings tend to receive less attention when they marry.

30 Parental 'basking' is advantageous for later siblings.

Questions 31–34

*Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C or D**.*

Write the correct letter in boxes 31–34 on your answer sheet.

31 What point does the writer make about birth order in the third paragraph?

A Its role is underestimated by parents.
B It may shape the characteristics of adults.
C Its importance decreases as children grow up.
D It has more influence on personality than genetics.

32 What are we told about some of Claire Cartwright's clients?

A Their parents treated them fairly.
B They were treated harshly by their siblings.
C Their perceptions of childhood may be inaccurate.
D They have closer relations with their siblings as adults.

33 What is the writer's main point about siblings in the fifth paragraph?

A Parents tend to repeat their own parents' mistakes.
B Favoured children are likely to make good leaders as adults.
C Negative characteristics in children can become positive in adults.
D Attention-seeking children are unlikely to please bosses in later life.

34 Which of the following best summarises the writer's argument in the sixth paragraph?

A Many children have a favourite parent.
B Parenting skills improve with later children.

C Siblings are born with different personalities.
D The family environment may change over time.

Questions 35–40

*Complete the summary using the list of words, **A–K**, below.*

*Write the correct letter, **A–K**, in boxes 35–40 on your answer sheet.*

The positive aspects of sibling relationships

Annette Henderson suggests that young children's interactions with older siblings involve **35** _____. Also, a Cambridge study found that siblings still enjoy **36** _____ even when they have a tendency to fight. Research conducted in 2003 suggests that children develop **37** _____ as a result of seeking attention. Another factor is the trend for smaller families, which may mean that today's siblings enjoy **38** _____ as adults. A 2010 American study linked having a sister with **39** _____ among children aged 10–14. Finally, having a sibling may promote **40** _____ according to the same study.

A parental love
B imaginative games
C physical development
D generous behaviour
E strong marriages
F greater individuality
G learning experiences
H career success
I closer relationships
J healthy competition
K mental well-being

ĐÁP ÁN:

27. **NO**
Vì bài nói rằng anh chị em còn có ảnh hưởng mạnh hơn cả cha mẹ trong việc hình thành con người trưởng thành:

"*even more influential in determining what kind of adult we will become are our brothers and sisters*"
=> Không phải cha mẹ và anh chị em có vai trò ngang nhau.

28. **NOT GIVEN**
Bài chỉ nói:

"*our brothers and sisters are the human beings who people our first social relationships*"
Không hề đề cập việc đó thường là anh/chị/em cùng giới tính.

29. **YES**
Bài nói mối quan hệ với anh chị em "ít mãnh liệt về cảm xúc hơn" so với vợ/chồng và con cái:

"*less emotionally intense than the bonds we form with our spouses and our own children*"
=> Khi kết hôn, mối quan hệ với siblings thường nhận ít sự chú ý hơn.

30. **YES**
Bài cho biết "parental basking" giúp cha mẹ nuôi dạy con nhỏ tích cực hơn và những đứa trẻ này có ít vấn đề hành vi hơn:

"*more positive parenting of younger children, who display fewer behavioural problems as a result*"
=> Có lợi cho các con sinh sau.

31. **B** — *It may shape the characteristics of adults.*
Đoạn 3 nói:

"*These are roles that can stick for life.*"
=> Thứ tự sinh có thể ảnh hưởng tính cách khi trưởng thành.

32. **C** — *Their perceptions of childhood may be inaccurate.*

"*they believe, and it might not have been true, that they were treated differently*"
=> Cảm nhận của họ về tuổi thơ có thể không chính xác.

33. **C** — *Negative characteristics in children can become positive in adults.*

"*the sibling who is disruptive and annoying as a child may be able to reinterpret that role later, turning those attention-seeking characteristics into strengths like determination and leadership*"
=> Đặc điểm tiêu cực lúc nhỏ có thể thành ưu điểm khi lớn.

34. **D** — *The family environment may change over time.*
Đoạn 6 nói cha mẹ và hoàn cảnh gia đình thay đổi theo thời gian:

"*The parents themselves are growing up too, weathering hardship or good fortune*"
=> Môi trường gia đình thay đổi theo thời gian.

35. **G — learning experiences**

"*younger children … benefit from unintentional instruction from their bigger brothers and sisters*"
=> Có sự học hỏi từ anh chị lớn.

36. **B — imaginative games**

"*siblings will still create a rich world of play and make-believe*"
=> "make-believe" = imaginative games.

37. **F — greater individuality**

"*developed stronger personalities and a better sense of their own identity*"
=> Hình thành cá tính riêng mạnh hơn.

38. **I — closer relationships**

"*siblings tend to know each other better and remain lifelong friends*"
=> Quan hệ gần gũi hơn khi trưởng thành.

39. **K — mental well-being**

"*less likely to feel lonely, unloved, self-conscious or fearful*"
=> Liên quan sức khỏe tinh thần.

40. **D — generous behaviour**

"*promoted good deeds, such as helping a neighbour … or helping other children*"
=> Hành vi tốt bụng, giúp đỡ người khác.